Class 33 Reading Homework

Era 12: Gilded Age (1877– 1900) · Focus: Industrialization · big business · monopoly

Reading due today: AMSCO 6.5, 6.6, 6.12

Connect: Gilded Age industrialists used the same 'natural laws' argument that antebellum slaveholders (Class 24) used to defend slavery as a 'positive good.' What's the pattern?

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **6.5 (LO D):** Explain the effects of technological advances in the development of the United States over time.

– **6.6 (LO E):** Explain the socioeconomic continuities and changes associated with the growth of industrial capitalism from 1865 to 1898.

– **6.12 (LO J):** Explain continuities and changes in the role of the government in the U.S. economy.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] Bessemer process
[ ] vertical/horizontal integration
[ ] monopoly
[ ] Social Darwinism
[ ] Gospel of Wealth

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] A. Carnegie
[ ] J.D. Rockefeller
[ ] J.P. Morgan
[ ] C. Vanderbilt

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] transcontinental RR completed (1869)
[ ] Sherman Antitrust Act (1890)

Government & the economy (CED 6.12) (identify each briefly)

[ ] laissez-faire
[ ] Interstate Commerce Act (1887) / ICC
[ ] Sherman Antitrust Act (1890) — enforcement & limits
[ ] Munn v. Illinois (1877)
[ ] Wabash v. Illinois (1886)
[ ] high protective tariffs (e.g., McKinley Tariff)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Compare Carnegie's 'vertical integration' with Rockefeller's 'horizontal integration.' Which strategy did each use, and why?

2. What was Carnegie's argument in 'Gospel of Wealth' — how did he justify huge private fortunes?

3. How did Social Darwinism provide intellectual cover for both inequality AND American imperialism?

4. How did the federal government's role in the economy change with the Interstate Commerce Act (1887) and the Sherman Antitrust Act (1890) — and how effective was early regulation against big business?